

Small claims prep for roommate debt, evidence collection, legal liability guide — Action Checklist

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DOCUMENT YOUR DAMAGES

- ☐ **Document Your Damages:** List every category of money owed, including rent shortfalls, utilities, shared household expenses, and any repairs you covered that were her responsibility.
- ☐ **Document Your Damages:** Assign specific dollar amounts to each line item and calculate your total by multiplying recurring expenses by the number of months she failed to pay.
- ☐ **Document Your Damages:** Categorize each claim by documentation strength as documentable, partially documentable, or estimate-only, so you know exactly which items will hold up in court.
- ☐ **Document Your Damages:** Verify your state's statute of limitations to confirm all claims fall within the legal time window before you invest time and money in this process.

BUILD YOUR EVIDENCE FILE

- ☐ **Build Your Evidence File:** Collect all receipts, bank statements, and transaction records that support each documentable and partially documentable claim you plan to file.
- ☐ **Build Your Evidence File:** Gather any written agreements, text messages, or emails where she acknowledged owing money or agreed to specific payment arrangements.
- ☐ **Build Your Evidence File:** Compile payment app history and written communications that show a pattern of late, missing, or incomplete payments from her to you.
- ☐ **Build Your Evidence File:** Organize your complete evidence file chronologically with clear labels so you can quickly locate any document during your hearing.

START THE LEGAL PROCESS

- ☐ **Start the Legal Process:** Send a formal demand letter that creates a legal record and starts the official response clock required before filing in small claims court.
 - ☐ **Start the Legal Process:** File your claim in the correct small claims court jurisdiction, which is typically where she currently resides or where your rental agreement was signed.
 - ☐ **Start the Legal Process:** Present your itemized claims with organized documentation during the hearing, showing each amount owed alongside its supporting evidence for the judge.
 - ☐ **Start the Legal Process:** Develop an enforcement strategy for your judgment, since having a court order doesn't guarantee automatic payment and you may need to pursue wage garnishment or bank levies.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.